

The Improve Phase

Brainstorm, pilot test, and roll out the fix that targets the root cause.

The Creative Stage

Improve is the fourth DMAIC step, the creative stage where you brainstorm solutions, test them, and implement the changes. Since our pizza shop's root cause is a broken dispatch system, we do not waste money on faster cars. We add a simple software alert that tells the kitchen when a driver is five minutes away.

Run a Pilot

In Six Sigma you never roll out a massive change and hope for the best. You run a pilot test first, a small controlled experiment. You try the new dispatch rule on just a quiet Tuesday night shift to prove it works and does not overwhelm the kitchen staff.

Why It Matters

Once the pilot succeeds and the data confirms the pizzas arrive hot, you confidently roll the improvement out to the entire operation. Testing small protects you from rolling a flawed fix across the whole business.

Remember this

Target the root cause, then pilot the fix before betting the whole operation on it.